

SANKALPA EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Realistic Fictional Simulation for HR / RAG Testing

Version 2.0 | Effective 01 October 2026 | Internal Use

IMPORTANT - FICTIONAL DOCUMENT

This handbook is a realistic simulation created for software prototypes, training, document retrieval and RAG evaluation. Sankalpa, its addresses, contacts and policies in this document are fictional. This document is not legal, HR, tax, benefits or employment advice.

Document owner: People Operations
Policy contact: peopleops@sankalpa.example
Classification: Internal / Demo Data

A. Document Control and Use

Document title	Sankalpa Employee Handbook
Version	2.0
Effective date	01 October 2026
Document owner	People Operations
Approved by	Executive Leadership Team - fictional simulation
Review cycle	Annual, or earlier when a material policy changes
Applies to	All Sankalpa employees unless a written employment agreement states otherwise
Primary contact	peopleops@sankalpa.example

How to use this handbook

This handbook explains common employment policies, expected workplace behavior, approval paths and operating procedures. Where a written employment agreement, benefits plan document or local statutory requirement is more specific, the more specific document controls.

- Managers are responsible for applying policies consistently and escalating unclear cases to People Operations.
- Employees should ask before acting when a policy is unclear, especially for travel, security, conflicts of interest or external communication.
- Nothing in this fictional handbook creates a contract of employment or guarantees continued employment, compensation, benefits or a particular work arrangement.
- Policy exceptions must be documented in writing by the authorized approver identified in the relevant section.

RAG testing tip

Policy IDs, defined terms, approval requirements, time limits and exception paths are intentionally explicit so retrieval systems can be tested on precise questions and edge cases.

B. Contents

Section	Topic	Policy ID
1	Welcome and Company Principles	HR-01
2	Employment Framework	HR-02
3	Working Hours, Timekeeping and Attendance	HR-03
4	Hybrid and Remote Work	HR-04
5	Leave and Time Off	HR-05
6	Compensation, Payroll and Overtime	HR-06
7	Benefits and Wellness	HR-07
8	Performance, Feedback and Development	HR-08
9	Workplace Conduct and Respect	HR-09
10	Grievances, Reporting and Non-Retaliation	HR-10
11	Information Security and Acceptable Use	SEC-01
12	Privacy, Confidentiality and Data Handling	SEC-02
13	Company Devices and Asset Management	IT-01
14	Travel and Expense Reimbursement	FIN-01
15	Health, Safety and Emergency Response	OPS-01
16	Conflicts of Interest, Gifts and Anti-Bribery	ETH-01
17	External Communications and Social Media	COM-01
18	Intellectual Property and Company Records	LEG-01
19	Corrective Action and Investigations	HR-11
20	Separation and Offboarding	HR-12
A1	Approval Matrix	APP-A
A2	Employee Scenarios and FAQs	APP-B
A3	Contacts, Glossary and Acknowledgment	APP-C

1. Welcome and Company Principles

Policy at a glance

Purpose	Set expectations for how employees work together and how this handbook should be interpreted.
Applies to	All employees.
Policy owner	People Operations.

Sankalpa is a fictional technology and operations company used in this handbook simulation. The company expects employees to deliver reliable work, protect customers and company information, raise concerns early and treat colleagues with professionalism.

Core working principles

- Customer trust: make decisions that protect users, customers and confidential information.
- Ownership: follow through on commitments, surface blockers early and document important decisions.
- Respect: challenge ideas without attacking people, and avoid harassment, discrimination or retaliation.
- Security by default: use approved systems, least-privilege access and secure handling practices.
- Learn and improve: seek feedback, share knowledge and correct mistakes transparently.

Manager responsibilities

- Explain team expectations and any role-specific procedures.
- Review leave, remote work, travel and expense requests within a reasonable time.
- Escalate potential safety, conduct, legal or security issues rather than handling serious matters informally.
- Avoid retaliation against employees who raise concerns in good faith.

2. Employment Framework

Policy at a glance

Employment categories	Regular full-time, regular part-time, fixed-term, intern/trainee, and approved contractor classifications.
Probation	May apply if stated in the employment letter.
Personnel records	Employees must keep contact, emergency and payment information current.

Employment records

- Employees must promptly update their personal contact details, emergency contact, bank/payment information and required identity or tax documentation through the HR system.
- Access to personnel files is limited to authorized business purposes.
- Changes to title, compensation, reporting line or employment status require documented approval before taking effect.

Role changes and transfers

Internal transfers may be considered based on role eligibility, performance, business need and manager release timing. Employees should not assume a transfer is final until they receive written confirmation from People Operations.

Important distinction

A verbal discussion about a promotion, transfer, salary change or conversion does not by itself change an employee's employment terms. Written confirmation is required.

3. Working Hours, Timekeeping and Attendance

Policy at a glance

Standard hours	9:00 AM to 5:30 PM, Monday through Friday.
Flexibility	Employees may request flexible arrangements from their manager.
Unplanned absence	Notify the manager before the workday begins, unless an emergency makes that impossible.
Attendance records	Employees must accurately record time or attendance when their role requires it.

3.1 Standard schedule

Sankalpa standard working hours are 9:00 AM to 5:30 PM, Monday through Friday. Team schedules may vary for customer coverage, shifts, releases or business continuity. Managers must communicate recurring schedule changes in advance where practical.

3.2 Flexible schedules

- Employees may request a different start/end time when business coverage is maintained.
- Flexible schedules are not automatic and may be changed or withdrawn when business needs change.
- Employees must remain reachable during agreed collaboration hours and attend required meetings.

3.3 Attendance and lateness

- If an employee expects to be late or absent unexpectedly, they should notify their manager before the workday begins.
- Repeated unexplained lateness, unreported absence or inaccurate time records may lead to corrective action.
- In an emergency, notification may be made as soon as reasonably possible by the employee or an appropriate contact.

Example

An employee whose commute is disrupted may ask to start remotely and arrive later. The manager can approve the arrangement if coverage and role requirements are met.

4. Hybrid and Remote Work

Policy at a glance

Eligibility	Hybrid work is available to eligible roles with manager approval.
Availability	Remote employees must remain available during agreed working hours.
Security	Company information must be protected regardless of work location.
Default simulation guideline	Eligible teams may normally approve up to 2 remote days per week unless a team policy states otherwise.

4.1 Approval and eligibility

Hybrid work is a work arrangement, not a permanent entitlement. Eligibility depends on the role, performance, security requirements, customer obligations and team coverage. Managers may require office attendance for onboarding, planning, customer work, training, incidents or other business needs.

4.2 Remote workspace requirements

- Use a reasonably private workspace and prevent unauthorized people from viewing or hearing confidential information.
- Use company-managed devices and approved networks, VPNs and applications when required.
- Do not print sensitive information at home unless specifically authorized and a secure disposal method is available.
- Report lost devices, suspected phishing, credential compromise or data exposure to IT immediately.

4.3 Temporary remote work

A short-term remote request due to travel disruption, minor illness, home maintenance or similar circumstances may be approved by the manager. Remote work is not automatically a substitute for sick leave when the employee is unable to work.

Cross-border work

Working from another country or jurisdiction requires advance approval from People Operations, Security and the relevant business leader because payroll, tax, immigration, data access and customer restrictions may apply.

5. Leave and Time Off

Policy at a glance

Annual leave	12 days per calendar year.
Sick leave	6 days per calendar year.
Planned leave	Request through the HR system and obtain manager approval before making non-refundable commitments.
Unplanned absence	Report to the manager before the workday begins when reasonably possible.

Leave type	Simulation entitlement	Approval / notice
Annual leave	12 days / calendar year	Manager approval; request in advance.
Sick leave	6 days / calendar year	Notify manager promptly; documentation may be requested for extended absence.
Bereavement	Up to 3 working days	Notify manager; People Operations can approve exceptions.
Marriage / personal event	Up to 2 working days	Manager approval; request in advance.
Parental / statutory leave	As applicable under the governing plan or law	Coordinate with People Operations.
Unpaid leave	Case-by-case	People Operations + manager approval.

5.1 Annual leave

- Annual leave should be planned to avoid critical delivery periods where reasonable.
- Managers should consider fairness, staffing, previously approved leave and operational commitments.
- For this simulation, up to 5 unused annual-leave days may carry forward into the next calendar year and should normally be used by 31 March. Any different rule in a benefits or local policy document controls.

5.2 Sick leave

- Sick leave is for an employee who is unwell or needs qualifying medical care.
- Employees should not work merely to avoid using sick leave if they are not fit to perform their duties safely.
- People Operations may request reasonable documentation for extended or repeated absence, subject to applicable rules.

Leave is not remote work

If an employee is too unwell to work, the appropriate status is sick leave rather than "working from home." A manager may approve remote work only when the employee is actually able to work.

6. Compensation, Payroll and Overtime

Policy at a glance

Pay cycle	Monthly, on the last working day of the month for this simulation.
Payroll corrections	Report suspected errors to payroll within 10 working days of the pay statement.
Overtime	Must be approved in advance when the role/policy requires paid overtime.

6.1 Salary and payroll

- Base salary and any fixed allowances are stated in the employee's written compensation documents.
- Applicable deductions may be made for taxes, benefits or other lawful and authorized purposes.
- Employees should review pay statements promptly and report suspected errors to payroll@sankalpa.example.

6.2 Overtime and additional hours

Employees should not assume that working additional hours creates an entitlement to overtime pay or compensatory time. Eligibility depends on role classification and applicable rules. Where prior approval is required, employees must obtain it before working additional scheduled hours except during genuine emergencies.

6.3 Compensation reviews

Compensation may be reviewed periodically based on market data, role scope, performance, internal equity and business conditions. A performance review does not guarantee a salary increase, bonus or promotion.

7. Benefits and Wellness

Policy at a glance

Core benefits	Health insurance and an annual wellness allowance for eligible employees.
Eligibility	Defined by the applicable benefit plan and employment category.
Questions	People Operations can explain eligibility, enrollment and claim processes.

7.1 Health insurance

Sankalpa provides health insurance to eligible employees under the terms of the applicable plan. Coverage levels, dependent eligibility, exclusions, waiting periods and claims procedures are governed by the plan documents. If this handbook conflicts with a plan document, the plan document controls.

7.2 Wellness allowance

- For this simulation, eligible employees may claim up to INR 12,000 per calendar year for approved wellness expenses.
- Examples may include fitness membership, preventive health checks, ergonomic accessories or approved mental-wellbeing services.
- Claims require a valid receipt and must be submitted within 30 days of purchase and before the annual cutoff communicated by People Operations.
- Cash, gift cards, alcohol, tobacco, gambling, personal electronics and non-wellness lifestyle purchases are not reimbursable under this allowance.

Plan documents control

Benefits are one of the areas where a handbook should not be treated as the only source. Eligibility, exclusions and claims are governed by the current plan terms.

8. Performance, Feedback and Development

Policy at a glance

Review cadence

Formal performance reviews twice each year.

Feedback

Employees and managers should exchange ongoing feedback between formal reviews.

Development

Training and development support may be approved based on role relevance and budget.

8.1 Performance reviews

Sankalpa conducts performance reviews twice each year. Reviews may consider goal delivery, role expectations, quality, collaboration, customer impact, security/compliance behavior and demonstration of company principles.

8.2 Performance improvement

When performance is below expectations, the manager should clarify the gap, expected standard, support available and review timeline. Depending on severity and circumstances, Sankalpa may use coaching, written expectations, a formal improvement plan or other corrective action.

8.3 Learning support

- Role-relevant courses, certifications or conferences may be approved when there is a clear business benefit.
- Approval should be obtained before booking or purchasing.
- Reimbursement may be subject to budget limits, completion evidence and any written learning agreement.

9. Workplace Conduct and Respect

Policy at a glance

Standard	Treat colleagues, customers, vendors and visitors respectfully.
Prohibited behavior	Harassment, discrimination, bullying, threats, retaliation, deliberate sabotage and serious dishonesty.
Reporting	Raise concerns with a manager, People Operations or the ethics channel.

9.1 Professional conduct

- Communicate respectfully, including in chat, email, meetings and code/document reviews.
- Do not engage in insulting, humiliating, discriminatory or sexually inappropriate conduct.
- Do not retaliate against a person for raising a good-faith concern or participating in an investigation.
- Do not intentionally damage company property, systems, records or another person's work.

9.2 Alcohol, drugs and impairment

Employees must not perform work while impaired in a way that creates a safety, security or performance risk. At company events where alcohol is legally permitted, employees remain responsible for professional behavior and safe transportation.

9.3 Workplace relationships

Employees should disclose a close personal or romantic relationship when one person directly or indirectly influences the other person's pay, performance rating, promotion, scheduling or employment decision. The company may adjust reporting lines or decision rights to manage the conflict.

10. Grievances, Reporting and Non-Retaliation

Policy at a glance

Channels	Manager, People Operations, ethics@sankalpa.example, or Security/IT for security incidents.
Confidentiality	Information is shared on a need-to-know basis; absolute confidentiality cannot be guaranteed.
Non-retaliation	Retaliation for good-faith reporting or participation in an investigation is prohibited.

10.1 Raising a concern

1. Use the channel that feels appropriate for the issue. Employees do not have to report to a manager who is involved in the concern.
2. Provide facts, dates, people involved and relevant documents when available. Avoid altering evidence.
3. People Operations or another authorized team will assess the concern and determine the appropriate review process.
4. The company will share outcomes to the extent appropriate, while respecting privacy and legal constraints.

10.2 Urgent concerns

- Immediate safety threat: contact local emergency services first, then company security or management.
- Suspected phishing, credential theft, device loss or data exposure: contact IT/Security immediately.
- Potential fraud, bribery, harassment or retaliation: contact People Operations or the ethics channel promptly.

Good-faith reporting

A report does not need to be proven correct to be protected as a good-faith report. Knowingly false or malicious allegations, however, may themselves violate policy.

11. Information Security and Acceptable Use

Policy at a glance

Passwords	Use strong, unique passwords and approved multi-factor authentication.
Devices	Protect company devices and do not disable security controls.
Incidents	Report suspected phishing, credential compromise, malware, device loss or data loss immediately.
Software	Use approved software and services for company data.

11.1 Account security

- Never share passwords, authentication codes, API keys or recovery codes with another person.
- Use the company password manager where provided and enable MFA on supported business systems.
- Lock screens when away from a device and prevent shoulder-surfing in public spaces.

11.2 Acceptable use

- Company systems are primarily for legitimate business use. Limited personal use may be permitted if lawful, low-risk and does not interfere with work.
- Do not install unauthorized software, bypass security tools, use company systems for illegal activity, or store company data in unapproved personal accounts.
- Do not upload confidential company or customer data into public AI tools, code assistants, file-sharing sites or consumer cloud services unless the service is approved for that data classification.

11.3 Incident reporting

Employees must report suspected phishing or data loss to IT immediately. Fast reporting is expected even when the employee is unsure whether an incident actually occurred. Employees should preserve evidence and avoid deleting suspicious messages or files unless Security instructs them to do so.

Security contact

For this simulation: security@sankalpa.example and ithelp@sankalpa.example. Lost device or suspected account takeover should be treated as urgent.

12. Privacy, Confidentiality and Data Handling

Policy at a glance

Need-to-know	Access and use information only when required for authorized work.
Storage	Use approved systems and follow classification/retention requirements.
Sharing	Verify recipient, purpose and sensitivity before sharing.
End of employment	Confidentiality obligations continue after separation where applicable.

Classification	Examples	Handling expectation
Public	Published website content, approved job posts	May be shared publicly after approval.
Internal	Routine internal process docs, internal org information	Share with Sankalpa personnel who need it.
Confidential	Customer data, contracts, source code, non-public financials	Approved systems; restricted access; encrypt where required.
Restricted	Credentials, security secrets, regulated or highly sensitive data	Strict least privilege; approved secure storage; enhanced controls.

12.1 Minimum necessary use

Employees should collect, access, copy, export and retain only the information needed for the approved business purpose. Convenience alone is not a reason to create personal copies of sensitive data.

12.2 Sending information

- Confirm the recipient and attachment before sending email or chat messages containing confidential information.
- Use approved secure transfer tools for large or sensitive files.
- Do not forward company email to personal accounts for convenience.

13. Company Devices and Asset Management

Policy at a glance

Ownership	Company-issued devices and accessories remain company property unless transferred in writing.
Care	Employees must take reasonable care of devices and report damage or loss promptly.
Return	All company property must be returned by the final working day unless otherwise instructed.

13.1 Device use

- Keep operating systems, endpoint security and required applications updated.
- Do not lend company devices to family members or other unauthorized people.
- Use approved encryption and screen-lock settings.
- Do not attempt hardware repairs or security modifications unless authorized by IT.

13.2 Lost or stolen devices

1. Notify IT/Security immediately.
2. Provide the device type, asset tag if known, last known location and time of loss.
3. Change credentials or follow containment instructions if requested.
4. File a police or venue report if instructed or appropriate.

Do not wait for certainty

If a device containing company data might be lost, report it immediately. Security can close the incident later if the device is found.

14. Travel and Expense Reimbursement

Policy at a glance

Travel approval	Written manager approval is required before booking business travel.
Expense standard	Reasonable, necessary business expenses are reimbursable when properly documented.
Receipt deadline	Submit receipts through the expense portal within 30 days.
Exceptions	Finance approval is required for policy exceptions or missing-document cases.

Expense	Default simulation rule	Notes
Air travel	Economy class for standard trips	Premium class requires documented exception approval.
Hotel	Reasonable market rate near business location	Use preferred suppliers where available.
Meals	Actual reasonable cost within local guideline	Personal alcohol is not reimbursable unless part of an approved client event.
Ground transport	Taxi/rideshare/public transport or mileage where approved	Choose safe, practical, cost-conscious options.
Internet / business calls	Reasonable business use while travelling	Receipt or itemized record required where available.

14.1 Before booking

- Obtain written manager approval describing the business purpose and approximate dates/cost.
- Use the approved booking channel when one is available.
- Do not select a materially more expensive option for personal convenience unless the employee pays the difference and the arrangement is approved.

14.2 Submitting expenses

1. Submit the expense in the portal within 30 days of the transaction or trip completion.
2. Attach an itemized receipt where available and state the business purpose.
3. Identify attendees for business meals or client entertainment when required.
4. Return any unused company advance or resolve rejected items promptly.

Example

A hotel receipt submitted 45 days after travel is outside the normal 30-day deadline. The employee should still submit it, explain the delay and obtain any required Finance exception approval rather than altering the date or omitting the expense.

15. Health, Safety and Emergency Response

Policy at a glance

Responsibility	Every employee should act safely and report hazards, injuries or emergencies.
Emergency priority	Protect people first; contact local emergency services when immediate help is needed.
Incident reporting	Report workplace injuries, near misses and significant safety hazards promptly.

15.1 Office and remote safety

- Keep exits, walkways and emergency equipment unobstructed.
- Follow building evacuation and visitor procedures.
- Report damaged electrical equipment, unsafe conditions or ergonomic concerns.
- Remote employees are expected to maintain a reasonably safe home workspace and follow basic ergonomic practices.

15.2 Emergencies

1. Move to safety and call emergency services where needed.
2. Follow site evacuation, shelter or emergency instructions.
3. Notify the manager or Workplace Operations when safe to do so.
4. Do not re-enter a restricted area until authorized.

16. Conflicts of Interest, Gifts and Anti-Bribery

Policy at a glance

Conflict rule	Disclose actual or potential conflicts before participating in the decision.
Bribery	Offering, requesting or accepting bribes or kickbacks is prohibited.
Gifts	Must be modest, infrequent, lawful and not intended to influence a business decision.

16.1 Common conflicts

- Selecting or managing a vendor owned by a close relative or someone with whom the employee has a significant personal relationship.
- Using confidential company information for personal investment or outside business advantage.
- Holding outside employment that interferes with Sankalpa duties or creates a competitive/confidentiality conflict.
- Hiring, evaluating or approving compensation for a person where there is a close personal relationship that could impair objectivity.

16.2 Gifts and hospitality

For this simulation, gifts with a value above INR 5,000 from a current or prospective vendor, customer or partner require written Ethics approval before acceptance. Cash or cash-equivalent gifts should not be accepted regardless of value. Lower-value gifts can still be inappropriate if they are frequent or connected to a pending decision.

Never split a gift or expense

Breaking one gift or expense into smaller amounts to stay below an approval threshold defeats the control and violates policy intent.

17. External Communications and Social Media

Policy at a glance

Spokespersons

Only authorized employees may speak on behalf of Sankalpa to media, investors or the public.

Personal social media

Employees may identify their employer but should make clear personal opinions are their own when context could imply otherwise.

Confidentiality

Do not disclose non-public company, customer or employee information.

17.1 Media and public inquiries

Employees who receive a media request, investor inquiry, legal inquiry or request for an official company statement should forward it to the authorized Communications or Legal contact rather than responding on the company's behalf.

17.2 Social media

- Do not post screenshots, roadmaps, source code, customer information, internal incidents, unreleased product details or confidential workplace discussions.
- Do not present personal views as official company policy.
- Employees remain responsible for respectful conduct when a post has a clear workplace connection.

18. Intellectual Property and Company Records

Policy at a glance

Work product

Rights in work created within the scope of employment are governed by the employee agreement and applicable law.

Open source

Use must comply with approved licensing and security processes.

Records

Business records must be accurate and retained or deleted according to approved schedules and legal holds.

18.1 Intellectual property

Employees should promptly disclose inventions, designs, code, models, documentation or other work product when required by their employment agreement or company process. Employees must not incorporate third-party material without permission or a compatible license.

18.2 Open-source software

- Review license obligations before using or distributing open-source components.
- Do not copy code from unknown sources into company products without review.
- Follow Security and Engineering procedures for dependency scanning and vulnerability management.

18.3 Records integrity

Employees must not falsify expenses, time records, customer records, test results, approvals or other business records. If a legal hold or investigation notice is issued, relevant records must not be deleted or altered until the hold is released.

19. Corrective Action and Investigations

Policy at a glance

Approach	Response depends on severity, facts, prior history, intent and risk.
Possible actions	Coaching, warning, improvement plan, access restriction, suspension, reassignment or separation.
Investigations	Employees are expected to cooperate honestly and preserve relevant information.

19.1 Corrective action

Sankalpa may use progressive corrective action where appropriate, but the company is not required to use every step in every case. Serious misconduct, security violations, fraud, violence, harassment, retaliation or deliberate falsification may justify accelerated action depending on the facts.

19.2 Investigation expectations

- Provide truthful information and relevant documents.
- Do not destroy, alter or conceal evidence.
- Do not retaliate against participants or attempt to coordinate false accounts.
- Respect confidentiality instructions intended to protect the process, while recognizing employees may have rights that cannot be waived by policy.

No automatic outcome

A complaint, investigation or allegation does not by itself establish misconduct. Decisions should be based on the available evidence and applicable standards.

20. Separation and Offboarding

Policy at a glance

Employee resignation	30 days written notice is expected.
Knowledge transfer	Complete reasonable handover before the final day.
Property return	Return company property before the final day unless otherwise instructed.
Access	System access may be changed or removed based on business and security needs.

20.1 Resignation

Employees who resign from Sankalpa are expected to provide 30 days of written notice. People Operations will confirm the final working date after considering the employment agreement, business handover and any mutually agreed adjustment.

20.2 Offboarding checklist

1. Confirm final working date and handover plan with the manager and People Operations.
2. Transfer project status, documentation, credentials held in approved shared systems and key operational knowledge.
3. Submit outstanding travel or expense claims and repay any amounts owed where applicable.
4. Return laptop, access cards, keys, peripherals and other company property.
5. Remove personal files from company devices only in accordance with IT instructions; do not delete business records.
6. Complete exit formalities and confirm personal contact/payment information for final documents where required.

20.3 Continuing obligations

Confidentiality, intellectual-property, non-solicitation or other post-employment obligations continue to the extent stated in the applicable agreement and law. Former employees must not retain company or customer data.

A1. Approval Matrix

Request / decision	Primary approver	Additional approval / note
Flexible work schedule	Manager	People Operations if recurring or materially different from team schedule.
Hybrid / remote arrangement	Manager	Security / People Operations for special or cross-border cases.
Annual leave	Manager	People Operations for policy exception.
Unpaid leave	Manager + People Operations	Business leader may be required for extended leave.
Business travel	Manager	Finance / leadership for exception or high-cost travel.
Expense outside policy	Finance	Manager confirms business purpose; additional approval may apply.
Gift above INR 5,000	Ethics & Compliance	Approval required before acceptance.
External speaking on behalf of company	Corporate Communications	Legal review when needed.
New software handling confidential data	Security / IT	Procurement / Privacy review as applicable.
Cross-border remote work	People Operations	Security + business leader; other specialist review as needed.

Decision records

Approvals should be retained in the system of record or in another durable written form. A chat message may be sufficient for a routine manager approval if it clearly states the request and decision, but higher-risk exceptions should use the designated workflow.

A2. Employee Scenarios and FAQs

Scenario 1 - Sick but able to work from home?

If the employee is well enough to work and the role is eligible, the manager may approve temporary remote work. If the employee is not fit to work, sick leave should be used. Remote work is not a substitute for medical recovery.

Scenario 2 - Forgotten travel receipt

Submit the claim within 30 days if possible. If the receipt is missing, provide alternative documentation and an explanation. Finance decides whether the expense can be reimbursed; the employee must not create or alter a receipt.

Scenario 3 - Suspicious email from the CEO

Do not rely on the sender name alone. Do not click links or send credentials. Report the message through the security channel immediately, especially if it asks for password resets, gift cards, payments or confidential files.

Scenario 4 - Vendor sends an expensive gift

If the value is above INR 5,000, written Ethics approval is required before acceptance. Cash or cash equivalents should not be accepted regardless of value. When in doubt, disclose and ask before accepting.

Scenario 5 - Working from another country for two weeks

Manager approval alone is not enough. Cross-border work requires advance review by People Operations, Security and the relevant business leader because immigration, tax, payroll, customer and data-location restrictions may apply.

Scenario 6 - Performance review is strong. Is a raise guaranteed?

No. Performance reviews and compensation decisions are related but separate. Compensation also depends on role scope, market data, internal equity and business conditions.

A2.1. Additional FAQs

Q: What are the standard working hours?

A: 9:00 AM to 5:30 PM, Monday through Friday, subject to role/team schedules and approved flexibility.

Q: How much annual and sick leave do employees receive?

A: 12 days of annual leave and 6 days of sick leave each calendar year under this simulation.

Q: Can I work remotely whenever I want?

A: No. Hybrid or remote work is for eligible roles and requires manager approval. Team and business needs still apply.

Q: When must an unplanned absence be reported?

A: Before the workday begins when reasonably possible. In a genuine emergency, report as soon as reasonably possible.

Q: How quickly must expenses be submitted?

A: Within 30 days through the expense portal, with receipts or other required documentation.

Q: How often are performance reviews held?

A: Twice each year.

Q: What should I do if I click a phishing link?

A: Report it to IT/Security immediately. Fast reporting helps reduce risk; do not hide the mistake.

Q: How much notice should I give if I resign?

A: 30 days written notice is expected, subject to the employment agreement and any mutually agreed adjustment.

A3. Contacts, Glossary and Acknowledgment

Key contacts - fictional

Function	Contact	Use for
People Operations	peopleops@sankalpa.example	Leave, benefits, employment records, workplace concerns.
Payroll	payroll@sankalpa.example	Pay statements, payroll corrections and deduction questions.
IT Help Desk	ithelp@sankalpa.example	Device, access and standard technology support.
Information Security	security@sankalpa.example	Phishing, account compromise, data loss and security incidents.
Ethics & Compliance	ethics@sankalpa.example	Conflicts, gifts, bribery, retaliation and serious conduct concerns.
Finance	finance@sankalpa.example	Travel, expense and reimbursement questions.
Corporate Communications	communications@sankalpa.example	Media, public speaking and official company statements.

Glossary

Business day	A scheduled working day for the relevant employee/team, excluding applicable holidays.
Confidential information	Non-public information that could harm Sankalpa, a customer, employee or partner if disclosed improperly.
Good-faith report	A concern raised with an honest belief that the information may indicate a problem, even if the concern is later not substantiated.
Manager approval	Documented approval from the employee's current accountable manager or authorized delegate.
Written approval	Approval captured in an approved system, email or other durable written record.

A3.1. Employee Handbook Acknowledgment

This acknowledgment is included only to make the fictional handbook feel like a complete HR artifact. It does not create a real agreement.

Fictional acknowledgment

I acknowledge that I received access to the Sankalpa Employee Handbook, understand that it is a policy reference, and know where to ask questions. I understand that policies may change and that more specific written agreements or plan documents may control where applicable.

Employee name

Employee ID

Signature

Date

Version history

Version	Effective date	Summary
1.0	Sample source version	Two-page fictional RAG demonstration with eight core policy topics.
2.0	01 Oct 2026	Expanded realistic simulation with policy IDs, procedures, scenarios, approval matrix and detailed controls.

End of handbook

Questions about this fictional simulation should be directed to peopleops@sankalpa.example. For real employment matters, use the policies and contacts of the actual employer.